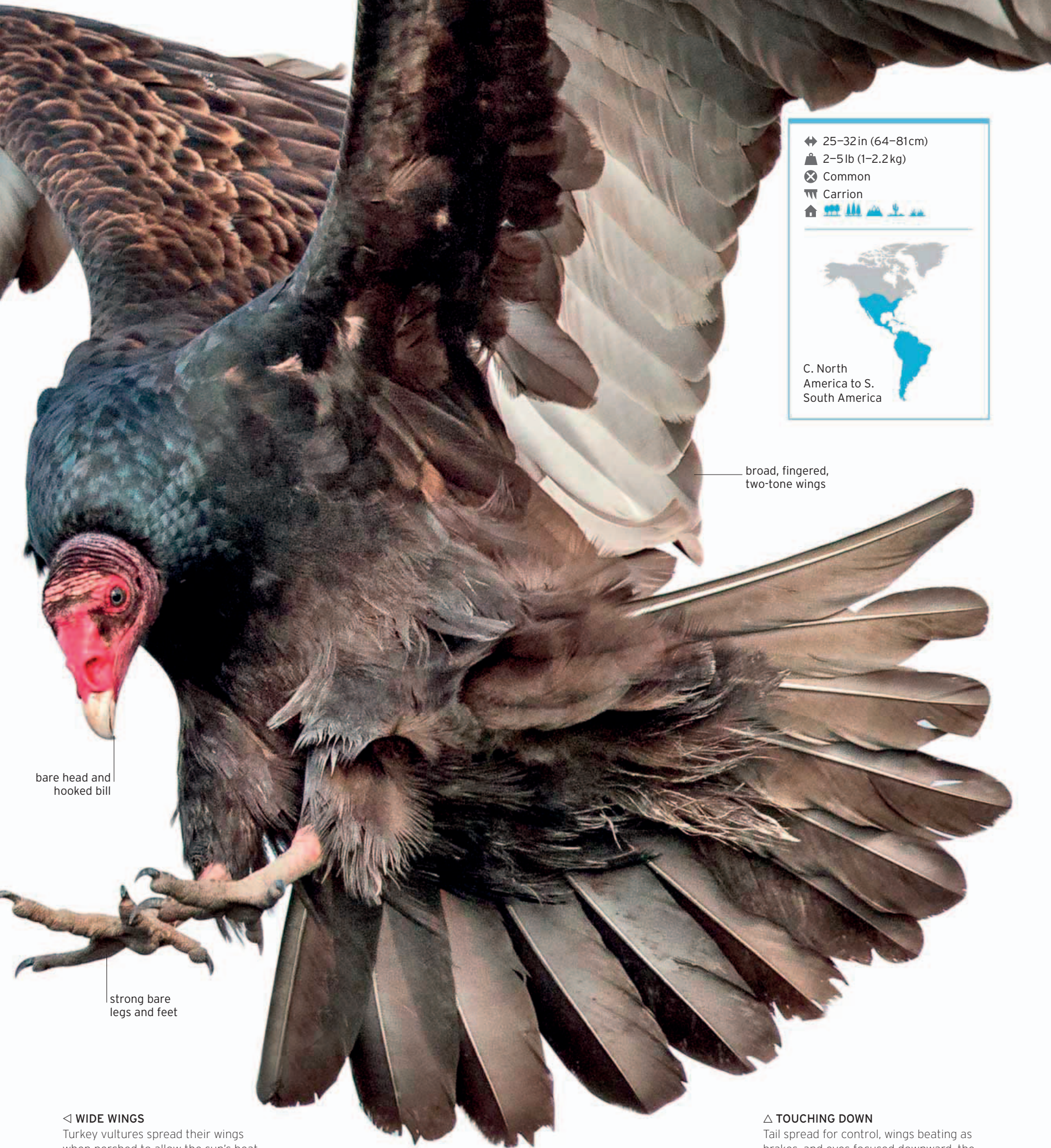




↔ 25–32 in (64–81 cm)

⚖ 2–5 lb (1–2.2 kg)

⊗ Common

🍖 Carrion



C. North
America to S.
South America

— broad, fingered,
two-tone wings

— bare head and
hooked bill

— strong bare
legs and feet

◁ WIDE WINGS

Turkey vultures spread their wings when perched to allow the sun's heat to warm their body in the morning and to dry wet feathers. This keeps their plumage in good condition.

△ TOUCHING DOWN

Tail spread for control, wings beating as brakes, and eyes focused downward, the vulture thrusts its feet forward to absorb the shock as it brings its substantial weight in to land.